Talent Intelligence

CHRO Recommendations Brief

Enova Technologies | Jan 2024 - Jul 2025 | Prepared by Talent Intelligence

HEADLINE NUMBERS

4,200	166	63	89.2%
Applications reviewed	**Hires made**	**Avg days to hire**	**Offer acceptance**
Jan 2024 - Jul 2025	3.95% conversion rate	vs 47 for Legal (fastest dept)	13 declines, 4 expired

FOUR FINDINGS

#	Finding	Evidence	Recommendation
1	**Technical Assessment bottleneck**	**Technology takes 6.3 days vs 2.6 for Data teams**	Cap assessments at 5 days. Assign a dedicated reviewer in Technology.
2	**Referral programme is Technology-only**	**26.3% conversion in Tech; 0 hires from referrals in 7 other depts**	Run structured referral campaigns in Commercial and Product.
3	**Headcount plan is off track**	**37% below plan in Q1-Q2 2025. Base case: 322 vs 500 target**	Revise year-end target to 350. Increase hiring velocity by 40%.
4	**HR attrition is a compounding risk**	**26.9% attrition in HR vs 10-11% company average**	Exit interview programme for HR team. Review scope and workload.

Data source: TalentFlow (ATS) and PeopleCore (HRIS) via enova_talent SQL Server database. Analysis covers Jan 2024 to Jul 2025 (18 months post-TalentFlow go-live). Pre-ATS employees (hired before Jan 2024) excluded from pipeline metrics.

CHRO RECOMMENDATIONS BRIEF

Talent Intelligence Analysis | Enova Technologies

CONTEXT

Enova closed its Series B in January 2024 and implemented TalentFlow, its first formal ATS, at the same time. This brief covers the 18 months since then. The dataset includes 4,200 applications across 45 job requisitions, 166 hires, and records for 345 employees (300 active, 45 terminated). Employees hired before January 2024 are excluded from pipeline metrics since no ATS data exists for them.

The analysis pulls from three source systems: TalentFlow for recruiting data, PeopleCore (HRIS) for employee records, and the Finance headcount plan. All three use different department naming conventions, which were resolved during the data cleaning phase before any analysis was run.

Four findings are presented below in order of business impact. Each includes the data behind it, a root cause assessment, and a specific recommendation with a suggested owner.

1 Technical Assessment is the primary bottleneck in the Technology hiring funnel

What the data shows

The Technical Assessment stage in Technology takes an average of 6.3 days. The same stage in Product takes 2.9 days and in Data and Analytics 2.6 days. That gap is not explained by role complexity alone. Senior roles across all three departments go through comparable assessments.

41.8% of Technology assessments exceed 7 days. In Product and Data and Analytics, zero assessments exceed 7 days. The problem is specific to Technology, not to technical hiring broadly.

6.3 days	2.9 days	2.6 days	41.8%
Technology avg	**Product avg**	**D&A; avg**	**Tech assessments over 7 days**
Technical Assessment stage	Technical Assessment stage	Technical Assessment stage	66 of 158 assessments

The Hiring Manager Screen is the joint slowest stage overall at 5.1 days average, but its variance is lower (stdev 3.1 days) than the Technical Assessment (stdev 4.2 days). The Technical Assessment is not just slow, it is unpredictable. Some candidates wait 18 days. Unpredictability at this stage is a candidate experience problem as much as a speed problem.

Root cause

Technology assessments are likely reviewed by the same senior engineers who are already at capacity. There is no dedicated reviewer pool and no SLA for returning feedback. Product and Data teams either have shorter assessments or clearer ownership of the review process.

Recommendation

Set a 5-day SLA for Technical Assessment completion in Technology. Assign two or three senior engineers as rotating assessment reviewers on a monthly basis, with 2 hours per week allocated in their schedules. If the assessment cannot be reviewed within 5 days, move the candidate to a live technical interview instead. The assessment format itself may need shortening. A 2-hour take-home task reviewed within 48 hours is better for candidate experience than a 4-hour task reviewed in 12 days.

Owner: Head of Engineering (assessment design) and Head of Talent Acquisition (SLA enforcement). **Timeline:** Process change can be implemented within 4 weeks.

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2 The referral programme works but only in Technology

What the data shows

Employee referrals convert at 10.3% overall, which is 2.7 times the company average of 3.95%. But that headline number obscures where the performance is coming from.

All 50 referral hires came from the Technology department. Technology referrals convert at 26.3%. Seven other departments received referral applications and produced zero hires between them.

26.3%	0%	4.18	30.1%
Referral conversion (Technology)	**Referral conversion (all other depts)**	**Referral quality of hire**	**Referral share of all hires**
50 hires from 190 applications	0 hires from 294 applications	vs company avg 3.67	50 of 166 total hires

Referral hires also score highest on quality of hire at 4.18 average performance rating, compared to 3.67 across all sources. LinkedIn Recruiter, which represents 18% of applications, converts at only 2.5% and scores 3.2 on quality of hire. The company is spending recruiter time on outbound sourcing that underperforms a programme that already exists and works well in one team.

Root cause

The Technology team likely has an informal but active referral culture. Engineers refer former colleagues without needing much prompting. Other departments do not have that culture yet, and the formal referral programme has not been communicated or incentivised strongly enough outside of Engineering.

Recommendation

Run a 90-day referral campaign in Commercial and Product specifically. Both departments have open roles, reasonable tenure, and employees with relevant networks. A referral bonus of EUR 1,500 to EUR 2,000 is standard for these markets. More important than the bonus is visibility: most employees do not refer because they do not know which roles are open or how easy the referral process is.

Track referral applications by department monthly. The goal is not to match Technology's 26.3% conversion rate immediately, but to get Commercial and Product referral conversion above 10% within six months. If that happens, the hiring velocity gap (see Finding 3) becomes easier to close.

Owner: Talent Acquisition team. **Timeline:** Campaign can launch within 3 weeks. Results visible within 60 days.

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3 The headcount plan is structurally off track and the 500 target is not achievable

What the data shows

In Q3 and Q4 2023, every department was above its headcount plan by an average of 120%. The company was hiring well ahead of Finance targets in the months after Series B closed. Q2 2024 was the only quarter where actual headcount matched the approved plan exactly.

From Q3 2024 onwards, the company has been below plan in every quarter. By Q4 2024, not one department hit its target. Q1 and Q2 2025 are both running 37% below approved headcount across the board.

Quarter	Approved	Actual	Variance	Depts below plan
Q3 2023	55	122	+67 (+122%)	0 of 6
Q4 2023	75	165	+90 (+120%)	0 of 6
Q2 2024	184	184	0 (on plan)	2 of 6
Q3 2024	234	182	-52 (-22%)	5 of 6
Q4 2024	236	140	-96 (-41%)	6 of 6
Q1 2025	318	199	-119 (-37%)	5 of 6
Q2 2025	343	214	-129 (-38%)	5 of 6

The forecast model, built on actual hiring and attrition velocity from the last six months, projects year-end headcount at 322 under the base case. The board target is 500. Closing that gap would require 28 hires per month. Current velocity is 6.

Scenario	Year-end HC	Gap to 500	% of target	Assumptions
Base case	322	178	64.4%	Current velocity unchanged
Optimistic	332	168	66.5%	+20% hires, -10% attrition
Pessimistic	312	188	62.3%	-15% hires, +20% attrition

Analytics is the most persistently off-plan department: 50% below plan in Q1 2025, 47.5% in Q2 2025, and 53% in Q4 2024. Three consecutive quarters at that gap is not a timing issue, it is a sourcing problem.

Root cause

Two things happened at once. The Finance plan assumed the post-Series B hiring pace would continue. It did not. The company slowed hiring in late 2024 for reasons not visible in this dataset (possibly budget constraints or a deliberate pause), while the approved headcount targets kept growing. The result is a plan that was ambitious when written and is now disconnected from operational reality.

Recommendation

The 500 target should be formally revised. A realistic year-end number based on current velocity and a 40% improvement in hiring pace is 350 to 370. Presenting a revised 370 target to the board is more credible than presenting 322 as a shortfall against 500.

The hiring velocity gap requires three things in parallel: more referrals (see Finding 2), faster time-to-hire in Product and Finance (the slowest departments), and a review of whether open requisitions are being actively worked or just sitting open. 11 requisitions are currently open. If those close in the next 60 days, that is 11 additional hires without increasing sourcing volume.

Owner: CHRO and CFO jointly (plan revision). Head of TA (velocity). **Timeline:** Board conversation needed within 30 days.

4 HR attrition is the highest in the company and creates a compounding risk

What the data shows

The HR department has a 26.9% attrition rate. The next highest is Operations at 20%. The company average is roughly 12.7%. HR is losing people at more than twice the rate of most other teams.

Department	Total	Left	Rate	Voluntary	Involuntary	Unknown
HR	26	7	**26.9%**	1	2	4
Operations	45	9	20.0%	3	2	2
Legal	16	2	12.5%	1	0	1
Product	37	4	10.8%	1	1	0
Commercial	57	6	10.5%	1	1	2
Engineering	116	12	10.3%	2	3	6
Finance	20	2	10.0%	1	0	1
Analytics	28	2	7.1%	0	1	1

Four of the seven HR departures have no recorded reason. The company does not know why most of its HR team left. That is a separate problem from the attrition rate itself.

40.7% of all company departures happen in the 7-12 month tenure band. This is the window after the probation period ends but before an employee is fully embedded. It points to onboarding quality or role fit more than compensation or career progression.

Why this matters beyond HR

HR attrition directly reduces the company's capacity to address Findings 1, 2, and 3. Every HR departure means less recruiting capacity, less time for process improvements, and more institutional knowledge lost. At 26.9% annual attrition, the HR team is effectively turning over every four years in a company that is only two years old.

Recommendation

Start with exit interviews for the HR team specifically. Given that 4 of 7 departures have no recorded reason, the first step is simply finding out why people are leaving. Without that, any retention action is guesswork.

Review the HR team's scope and workload. A company that grew from 50 to 300 employees in 18 months typically under-resources its People function during the growth phase. If the HR team is stretched, attrition will continue regardless of pay.

On the 7-12 month attrition pattern company-wide: implement a structured 6-month check-in for all new hires. A 30-minute conversation with an HR business partner at month six costs very little and catches issues before they become resignations.

Owner: CHRO (exit interview programme). Head of People Operations (onboarding review). **Timeline:** Exit interview process can start immediately with existing leavers.

SUMMARY

The four findings point to the same underlying tension: the company scaled headcount faster than its people processes could keep up. TalentFlow was only implemented 18 months ago, and the data quality gaps (35% of

rejection reasons unrecorded, 40% of employees not linked to their ATS record) reflect a team that was hiring at pace without the infrastructure to track it properly.

None of the four findings require significant budget. The Technical Assessment fix requires process discipline, not new tools. The referral campaign requires a bonus structure that likely already exists. The headcount plan revision requires a conversation, not a restructure. The HR attrition investigation requires exit interviews.

The one thing that does require budget is recruiting capacity. At 6 hires per month, the company cannot close the headcount gap. That pace needs to reach at least 10 to hit a revised year-end target of 350 to 370. Whether that means additional recruiters, an agency arrangement for specific hard-to-fill roles, or a referral bonus increase is a decision for the CHRO and CFO to make together.

DATA SOURCES AND METHODOLOGY

All analysis was conducted against the enova_talent SQL Server database. Source systems: TalentFlow (ATS) and PeopleCore (HRIS). Data window: January 2024 to July 2025 (18 months post-TalentFlow go-live). Pre-ATS employees (hired before January 2024) are excluded from pipeline metrics. Performance ratings are available for employees with 6+ months tenure and at least one review cycle. Rejection reasons are missing for 35.7% of rejected applications and are noted as a limitation throughout. The headcount forecast uses a 6-month lookback period for velocity calculations.

SQL analysis script: src/02_sql/19_analysis.sql | Forecast model: src/03_analysis/headcount_forecast.py | Repository: github.com/dobadina/enova-talent-intelligence